GREENFIELD UNIVERSITY

University Rules and Regulations

General rules for students, faculty and staff

Academic Year 2026–2027 | Document No. GU-REG-001 | Version 3.2

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This document is the official source of general university rules. In case of conflict with any informal notice, this document and its latest amendments prevail.

Section 1: General Provisions

1.1 **Title and application.** These rules are called the Greenfield University Rules and Regulations. They apply to every student, research scholar, faculty member, staff member, visitor and contractor on any campus or in any online learning platform of the University.

1.2 **Purpose.** The rules exist to protect a safe, fair and respectful learning environment, to set clear academic expectations and to ensure that every member of the University community is treated equally and without discrimination.

1.3 **Equal opportunity.** The University does not discriminate on the basis of gender, religion, ethnicity, nationality, disability, age or economic background in admission, teaching, assessment, employment or the provision of facilities.

1.4 **Language of instruction.** The primary language of instruction is English. Courses in other languages may be offered by approval of the Academic Senate.

1.5 **Governing bodies.** The Board of Governors determines policy and finances. The Academic Senate is responsible for curricula, examinations and academic standards. The Registrar administers student records. The Dean of Students oversees student welfare and discipline.

1.6 **Duty to know the rules.** Ignorance of these rules is not accepted as an excuse for a violation. Students are expected to read this document at registration and to check the University website and official email for updates.

1.7 **Official communication.** The University communicates through the official student email address, the student portal and notice boards. Students must check their official email at least once every working day.

1.8 **Identity cards.** Every student must carry the University identity card on campus and show it on request to security staff, examiners, librarians and faculty. A lost card must be reported within 48 hours, and a replacement costs 150 birr.

Section 2: Admission and Registration

2.1 Admission requirements

2.1.1 Undergraduate applicants must hold a recognised secondary school completion certificate and meet the minimum entrance score set for the chosen programme.

2.1.2 Postgraduate applicants must hold a recognised bachelor degree with a minimum cumulative grade point average (CGPA) of 2.50 out of 4.00, or an equivalent qualification.

2.1.3 Doctoral applicants must hold a recognised master degree, submit a research proposal of at most 3,000 words and pass an interview before a faculty panel.

2.1.4 International applicants must provide a valid passport, proof of English proficiency (IELTS 6.0, TOEFL iBT 70, or equivalent) and, where required, a student visa.

2.2 Required documents

2.2.1 Every admitted student must submit the original and one photocopy of: academic certificates and transcripts, national identity card or passport, four passport-size photographs, a medical fitness certificate and the signed admission acceptance form.

2.2.2 The University verifies all documents. Submission of forged or altered documents results in cancellation of admission without refund and may be reported to the authorities.

2.3 Course registration

2.3.1 Registration for each semester takes place through the student portal during the period announced in the Academic Calendar. A student who does not register within the period is not considered enrolled for that semester.

2.3.2 An undergraduate student must register for a minimum of 12 and a maximum of 18 credit hours per semester. A student with a CGPA of 3.50 or above may apply to the Dean for permission to register for up to 21 credit hours.

2.3.3 Late registration is allowed for a maximum of five working days after the deadline and carries a late fee of 500 birr.

2.3.4 Adding or dropping a course is permitted only during the first two weeks of a semester. After this period a course may be withdrawn from only up to the end of week 10, and a grade of W (Withdrawn) is recorded.

2.3.5 A student must meet the prerequisites of every course. Registration in a course without the prerequisite is cancelled by the Registrar without notice.

2.4 Deferment, readmission and transfer

2.4.1 A student may defer studies for a maximum of two consecutive semesters, with approval of the Dean, for medical, family or financial reasons supported by documents.

2.4.2 A student who is absent for more than two consecutive semesters without approved deferment is considered to have withdrawn and must apply for readmission.

2.4.3 Transfer from another recognised institution is accepted only into the second or third year. A maximum of 50 percent of the total credit hours of a programme may be transferred, and only for courses passed with grade C or above.

Section 3: Academic Calendar and Attendance

3.1 **Structure of the year.** The academic year has two semesters of 16 weeks each (September to January and February to June) and an optional summer term of eight weeks. Each semester includes 14 weeks of teaching, one revision week and two weeks of final examinations.

3.2 **Official holidays.** The University is closed on national public holidays and on the dates declared in the Academic Calendar. Classes missed due to closure are rescheduled by the Department.

3.3 **Minimum attendance.** A student must attend at least 80 percent of the scheduled lectures, tutorials and laboratory sessions of every course. Attendance is recorded by the instructor in every session.

3.4 **Attendance below the minimum.** A student whose attendance in a course is below 80 percent is not allowed to sit the final examination of that course and receives a grade of NG (Not Graded). Attendance between 75 and 79 percent may be condoned by the Dean on medical grounds with valid documents.

3.5 **Medical absence.** Absence due to illness must be reported to the Department within three working days. A medical certificate issued by a registered practitioner must be submitted within seven days of returning to class.

3.6 **Punctuality.** A student arriving more than 15 minutes after the start of a class may be marked absent at the discretion of the instructor.

3.7 **University representation.** Students representing the University in sports, cultural or academic events are given approved leave. Such leave is counted as attendance, provided the Department receives the official letter at least three days in advance.

3.8 **Class conduct.** Mobile phones must be silenced during lectures and examinations. Recording of lectures requires prior permission of the instructor.

Section 4: Examinations and Assessment

4.1 Components of assessment

4.1.1 Unless the Senate approves otherwise, a course is assessed by continuous assessment (quizzes, assignments, projects, laboratory work and mid-semester test) carrying 40 to 50 percent, and a final examination carrying 50 to 60 percent of the total mark.

4.1.2 To pass a course, a student must obtain a minimum of 40 percent in the final examination and a minimum of 50 percent in the overall total.

4.1.3 The instructor announces the assessment scheme in the course outline in the first week of the semester. The scheme cannot be changed after that week.

4.2 Examination rules

4.2.1 Final examination timetables are published at least three weeks before the first examination. Students must verify their own examination dates and venues.

4.2.2 A student must arrive at least 20 minutes before the start of an examination. No student is admitted after 30 minutes from the start, and none may leave in the first 30 minutes.

4.2.3 Only the identity card, pens, pencils and approved items (such as a non-programmable calculator) may be taken to the examination desk. Bags, notes, phones, smart watches and any electronic devices must be left at the front of the hall.

4.2.4 Possession of unauthorised material, communication with another candidate or copying is treated as an examination offence under Section 6.

4.2.5 Answer scripts are anonymised using candidate numbers. Scripts are double-marked, and the external examiner moderates a sample of at least 10 percent in each course.

4.3 Missed examinations and re-sit

4.3.1 A student who misses a final examination for a serious reason (illness, bereavement, or an emergency) may apply to the Dean within five working days for a make-up examination, attaching documentary evidence.

4.3.2 A student who fails a course may re-sit the final examination once at the next offering. The maximum grade awarded for a re-sit is C.

4.3.3 A student who fails the same course twice must repeat the course. A course may be repeated a maximum of two times.

4.4 Results and review of marks

4.4.1 Results are published on the student portal within 21 days after the last examination of the semester. Results are confidential and are not given by telephone.

4.4.2 A student may request a review (re-marking) of a final examination script within seven days of the publication of results by submitting the review form and paying a fee of 300 birr. The fee is refunded if the review results in a change of grade.

Section 5: Grading System and Academic Standing

5.1 The University uses a four-point grading scale. Marks are converted to letter grades and grade points as shown below.

Marks (%)	Grade	Grade points	Description
90 – 100	A+ / A	4.00	Outstanding
85 – 89	A−	3.75	Excellent
80 – 84	B+	3.50	Very good
75 – 79	B	3.00	Good
70 – 74	B−	2.75	Above average
65 – 69	C+	2.50	Satisfactory
60 – 64	C	2.00	Acceptable
50 – 59	D	1.00	Marginal pass
Below 50	F	0.00	Fail

5.2 Special grades. I = Incomplete (work pending for approved reasons, to be completed within 30 days), W = Withdrawn, NG = Not Graded (attendance shortage), P = Pass (non-credit courses).

5.3 CGPA. The Cumulative Grade Point Average is the total of (grade points × credit hours) for all courses divided by the total credit hours attempted. When a course is repeated, the latest grade replaces the earlier grade in the CGPA, and both remain on the transcript.

5.4 Academic standing

5.4.1 **Good standing.** A student with a CGPA of 2.00 or above at the end of a semester is in good standing.

5.4.2 **Academic probation.** A student with a CGPA below 2.00 is placed on academic probation for the next semester and is limited to 12 credit hours. The student must meet an academic adviser every month during probation.

5.4.3 **Dismissal.** A student who remains below a CGPA of 2.00 for two consecutive semesters on probation, or whose semester GPA is below 1.00 in any semester after the first, is dismissed from the University. A dismissed student may appeal to the Academic Appeals Committee within 14 days.

5.4.4 **Dean's List.** A student with a semester GPA of 3.75 or above, with no grade below C and a minimum of 15 credit hours, is placed on the Dean's List and receives a certificate.

5.5 Graduation requirements

5.5.1 To graduate, an undergraduate student must complete all required credit hours of the programme (normally 120 to 140), obtain a CGPA of at least 2.00, have no outstanding fees, library dues or disciplinary cases, and clear the exit clearance form.

5.5.2 The maximum period to complete a four-year undergraduate programme is seven years from the date of first registration.

5.5.3 **Degree classification.** First Class with Distinction: CGPA 3.75 and above. First Class: 3.25 to 3.74. Second Class: 2.50 to 3.24. Pass: 2.00 to 2.49.

Section 6: Academic Integrity

6.1 **Principle.** Every student must submit work that is honestly their own. The University regards academic dishonesty as a serious offence that damages the value of every degree awarded.

6.2 **Plagiarism.** Presenting the words, ideas, data, code or images of another person as one's own without proper acknowledgement is plagiarism. All theses, projects and major assignments are checked with similarity detection software, and a similarity score above 20 percent (excluding references) requires a written explanation.

6.3 **Other offences.** The following are also violations: cheating in an examination, copying from another student, allowing another student to copy, impersonation, buying or selling assignments, fabricating data or references, and submitting the same work for credit in more than one course without permission.

6.4 **Use of AI tools.** The use of generative AI tools in assessed work is allowed only when the course outline permits it. Where permitted, the student must clearly state which tool was used and for what purpose. Undeclared use of AI tools to produce submitted work is academic dishonesty.

6.5 Penalties for academic dishonesty

Penalties depend on the seriousness and on whether the offence is a first or repeated one. The Academic Integrity Committee decides every case after hearing the student.

Offence	First occurrence	Repeated occurrence
Minor plagiarism in an assignment	Zero mark for the assignment and written warning	Fail grade (F) in the course
Major plagiarism in a project or thesis	Fail grade (F) in the course	Suspension for one semester
Cheating in an examination	Zero in the examination and fail grade (F) in the course	Suspension for two semesters or dismissal
Impersonation, forgery or data fabrication	Suspension for one to two semesters	Permanent dismissal

6.6 **Process.** The instructor reports a suspected offence to the Head of Department within three working days. The student is informed in writing and has the right to respond and to be accompanied by a friend or student representative at the hearing.

Section 7: Code of Conduct and Disciplinary Procedure

7.1 Expected behaviour

7.1.1 Every member of the University community must treat others with courtesy and respect, obey the law and follow lawful instructions of University officials and security staff.

7.1.2 Students must dress modestly and appropriately for an academic environment. Laboratories and workshops may require protective clothing, which must be worn at all times.

7.1.3 Students must protect University property. The cost of damage caused deliberately or by negligence is recovered from the person responsible.

7.2 Prohibited conduct

7.2.1 **Harassment and violence.** Physical violence, threats, bullying, ragging or hazing, sexual harassment, stalking and discrimination of any kind are strictly prohibited and are punished with severe penalties including dismissal and referral to the police.

7.2.2 **Substances.** Possession, use, sale or distribution of illegal drugs is prohibited on campus. Alcohol and smoking are not permitted inside university buildings, hostels, or within 20 metres of a building entrance.

7.2.3 **Weapons.** Carrying firearms, knives, explosives or any dangerous item on campus is prohibited.

7.2.4 **Political and religious activity.** Students may hold peaceful discussions and associations, but activities that disrupt classes, incite hatred or violence, or use University facilities without permission are not allowed. Campaigning for political parties on campus is not allowed.

7.2.5 **Misuse of digital services.** Hacking, spreading malicious software, sharing another person's password, posting abusive or defamatory content and violating copyright are prohibited.

7.3 Disciplinary procedure

7.3.1 A complaint is submitted in writing to the Dean of Students. The Dean may impose an interim measure (such as barring entry to campus) for up to 10 working days where safety is at risk.

7.3.2 The Disciplinary Committee, with five members including a student representative, investigates the complaint. The student receives a written notice of the allegation at least five working days before the hearing and may present evidence and witnesses.

7.3.3 The Committee decides on the balance of probabilities and informs the student in writing within 10 working days after the hearing.

7.3.4 **Sanctions** include: (a) verbal or written warning; (b) community service; (c) fine; (d) restriction from facilities; (e) removal from the hostel; (f) suspension for one or more semesters; (g) dismissal; and (h) withholding of the degree or transcript.

7.3.5 A student may appeal against a sanction to the Vice Chancellor within 14 days of receiving the decision. The appeal decision is final.

Section 8: Library, Laboratories and IT Services

8.1 Library

8.1.1 The Main Library is open from 8:00 AM to 10:00 PM from Monday to Saturday and from 10:00 AM to 6:00 PM on Sunday. During examination periods it remains open until midnight.

8.1.2 An undergraduate student may borrow up to five books for 14 days, a postgraduate student up to ten books for 28 days. Loans may be renewed twice if no other reader has reserved the item.

8.1.3 Overdue books attract a fine of 5 birr per book per day. A lost or damaged book must be replaced or paid for at its current price plus a handling fee of 100 birr.

8.1.4 Silence must be observed in reading rooms. Food, drinks and the use of mobile phones for calls are not allowed in the library.

8.2 Laboratories and workshops

8.2.1 Students may use a laboratory only under supervision or with written approval of the laboratory in-charge. Safety instructions are mandatory, and failure to follow them leads to immediate removal from the session.

8.2.2 Food and drink are prohibited in laboratories. Equipment must be returned in good condition, and any breakage must be reported at once.

8.3 Computing, network and e-learning

8.3.1 Every student receives an official email account, a student portal login and access to the learning management system and campus Wi-Fi.

8.3.2 Credentials are personal. Students are responsible for all activity under their account and must not share their passwords.

8.3.3 Campus bandwidth is for academic use. Streaming of entertainment, torrenting, gaming servers and cryptocurrency mining are prohibited and may lead to loss of network access.

8.3.4 The IT Help Desk is open from 8:30 AM to 5:00 PM on working days and can be reached at **helpdesk@greenfield.edu**.

Section 9: Fees, Scholarships and Refunds

9.1 Payment of fees

9.1.1 Tuition and other fees are published every year by the Finance Office. Fees must be paid in full or by approved instalments before the end of the registration period.

9.1.2 A student with unpaid fees cannot register, sit examinations, receive results, transcripts or certificates, or graduate until the balance is cleared.

9.1.3 Payment is made through the University bank account or the approved online payment channel. The student must keep the receipt until graduation.

9.1.4 Instalment plans (two or three instalments per semester) may be approved by the Finance Office on request, before the registration deadline, and carry no interest.

9.2 Refund policy

Refunds of tuition fees apply only when a student officially withdraws in writing. Registration and application fees are non-refundable.

Time of official withdrawal	Refund of tuition
Before the start of the semester	100 percent
During weeks 1 and 2	75 percent
During weeks 3 and 4	50 percent
During weeks 5 and 6	25 percent
After week 6	No refund

9.3 Scholarships and financial aid

9.3.1 **Merit scholarships.** Students who rank in the top five percent of their entering class receive a tuition waiver of 25 to 100 percent. To renew the scholarship, the student must maintain a CGPA of at least 3.50 and not be subject to any disciplinary sanction.

9.3.2 **Need-based aid.** Students facing financial hardship may apply to the Financial Aid Committee with income evidence and a recommendation letter. Applications are accepted within the first three weeks of each semester.

9.3.3 **Work-study.** Eligible students may work up to 15 hours a week in library, laboratory or office roles at an hourly rate set by the University.

9.3.4 A scholarship is cancelled immediately if it was obtained through false information, and the amount received must be repaid.

Section 10: Hostel and Campus Residence

10.1 Hostel rooms are allotted each year on the basis of need, distance from home and academic merit. Allotment is not transferable and does not carry over to the next year automatically.

10.2 Hostel gates close at 10:00 PM. Late entry requires prior written permission of the Warden. Visitors are allowed only in the reception area from 4:00 PM to 7:00 PM.

10.3 Cooking appliances, heaters, irons and other high-power appliances are not allowed in rooms. Rooms are inspected monthly with prior notice. Silence hours are 10:00 PM to 6:00 AM.

Section 11: Health, Safety and Security

11.1 The University Health Centre offers free first aid and basic consultation for students from 8:00 AM to 8:00 PM. In emergencies after hours, contact campus security, who provide transport to the nearest hospital.

11.2 All students are expected to know the location of fire exits and assembly points. Fire drills are held twice a year and participation is mandatory. Tampering with fire equipment is a serious offence.

11.3 The Counselling Centre provides free and confidential counselling for academic, personal and mental health concerns. Students are encouraged to seek help early.

11.4 Security staff may check bags at the gates. Theft or any suspicious activity must be reported immediately to security at the 24-hour number below.

Section 12: Grievance Redressal

12.1 A student with a complaint about teaching, assessment, administration or treatment by any member of the University should first raise it informally with the person concerned or the Head of Department.

12.2 If unresolved within 10 working days, the student may submit a written complaint to the Student Grievance Cell. The Cell acknowledges it within three working days and gives a decision within 20 working days.

12.3 Complaints of sexual harassment are handled by the Internal Complaints Committee in strict confidence. Nobody may be punished for making a complaint in good faith.

Section 13: Amendments and Contacts

13.1 The Academic Senate and Board of Governors may amend these rules. Amendments take effect on the date of publication on the University website, and students must follow the latest version.

Office	Email	Phone
Registrar	registrar@greenfield.edu	+251 11 000 1001
Dean of Students	dean.students@greenfield.edu	+251 11 000 1002
Finance Office	finance@greenfield.edu	+251 11 000 1003
IT Help Desk	helpdesk@greenfield.edu	+251 11 000 1004
Campus Security (24 hours)	security@greenfield.edu	+251 11 000 1999